

Yangxu Lin

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Personal statement

Yangxu is currently a Research Assistant at the University of Oxford's Department of Social Policy and Intervention (DSPI). She holds an **MSc in Economics for Development from the University of Oxford's** Department of Economics and the Oxford Department of International Development (ODID).

Her research interests lie in **development economics** and **applied microeconomics**, with a focus on **human-capital formation** and its **returns in the labour market**. On the formation side, she is interested in how policies, interventions, and household decisions shape investments in education, health, and well-being. On the returns side, she is interested in how the human capital generated by these investments translates into later labour-market outcomes, and how technological change and shifts in labour demand later its returns. More broadly, she is interested in interaction between these two processes: how labour-market opportunities and the returns to different forms of human capital feed back into earlier investment decisions by individuals, households, and policymakers. Her current work focuses primarily on human-capital formation among children and adolescents in LMICs. Methodologically, her work draws on causal inference, econometrics, and economic evaluation to study policy-relevant questions in economics.

At Oxford, she works with the [Accelerate Research Hub](#) and collaborates with UNICEF, the Gates Foundation, and NGOs and government ministries across Africa. She works closely with trial leads on a randomised controlled trial (RCT) focused on schooling and learning and leads costing analyses of scale-up scenarios for existing RCTs across Africa, helping inform NGO and government programming. She has also contributed to several high-impact investment case studies, including work on ending child marriage in Ethiopia and Northern Nigeria. She led the quantitative modelling and return-on-investment analysis, and contributed to drafting of a WHO road safety investment case in Tunisia. She also contributed to the economic evaluation of a sugar-sweetened beverage tax in Thailand while serving with UNDP.

Outside academia, Yangxu is committed to community engagement and social impact. In China, she volunteered with the Changcheng Love Camp in her hometown for four years. She has also served as a mentor to a refugee in Burundi seeking admission to graduate study in the UK. She is expected to serve as the MIT Alumni Startups (MIT AS) Ambassador for London, helping to organise alumni events across the UK.

Appointments

University of Oxford (Oxford)

Research Assistant, Department of Social Policy and Intervention
2024-Present

Previous

Appointments

R-Health Consult (Remote)

Intern Economist
2023

UNDP – HIV, Health, and Development Unit (Remote)

United Nations Volunteer
2023

ZS Associates (Shanghai)

Part-time Associate in Healthcare Consulting
2022

Ipsos (Shanghai)

Full-time Social Intelligence & Analytics Intern
2022

China Securities (Beijing)

Investment Banking Intern
2021

Education**MSc Economics**

University of Oxford (2023-2024)

BSc Economics

Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool University (XJTLU) & University of Liverpool (2017-2021)

Credential

[MicroMasters in Data, Economics, and Design of Policy, 2023](#)

MIT (via MITx Online)

Standard tests

GRE 2025: verbal 162, quant 167, analytical writing 5

Duolingo English Test 2025: total 145/160 (writing 160/160)

Research grants, scholarship, and awards

- 2024 St Hugh's College (Oxford) Alumni Grant Fund for research in Africa £750
- 2024 St Hugh's College (Oxford) Barbinder Watson Fund for conference travel £250
- 2021 XJTLU BSc Economics: Best Overall Academic Performance Prize
- 2020 XJTLU BSc Economics: Academic Excellence Award Scholarship RMB10,000 (rank 1st in AY2019-20)
- 2019 XJTLU BSc Economics: Academic Excellence Award Scholarship RMB10,000 (rank 1st in AY2018-19)
- 2018 XJTLU BSc Economics: Academic Excellence Award Scholarship RMB10,000 (rank 1st in AY2017-18)
- 2018 Bureau of Education in Jiangsu Province, China: Merit-Based Outstanding Student

Publications

1. **Lin, Y.**, Adesina, O., Asuma, B. S., Chen-Charles, J., Chalasani, S., Cluver, L., Diop, R. A., Rudgard, W. E. (corresponding author). *Journal of Adolescent Health*, forthcoming 2026. [Preprint](#).

Work-in-progress

1. Teng D, **Lin Y (Corresponding author)**. Where do robots create skilled jobs: Evidence from European talent flows.
2. **Lin Y**, Rudgard WE. Labour-market returns to literacy and numeracy: Evidence from Ethiopia.
3. Mwala D, **Lin Y**, Cluver L. A systematic review of the effect of climate-related anticipatory cash transfers on household food security and child nutrition outcomes in low- and middle-income countries. [Protocol](#)
4. **Lin Y**. Climate change and child labour: Evidence from Ethiopia.

Writing samples

5. **Lin Y.** The relative merit of conditional and unconditional cash transfers. Oxford term essay (Distinction).
6. **Lin Y.** Foreign direct investment, domestic investment, and economic performance: evidence from China. XJTLU BSc Economics dissertation (First-class; 85%).
7. **Lin Y.** A path of development for resource-rich and capital-scarce African countries. Oxford MSc Economics application writing sample.
8. **Lin Y.** Is a rise in world oil price a blessing or a curse for Nigeria in terms of manufacturing output? XJTLU term essay (92%, rank 1st).
9. **Lin Y.** Public goods game and punitive mechanisms. XJTLU term essay (96%, rank 1st).

Policy documents

1. UNICEF. Harnessing Community Health Workers to Improve Adolescent Health and Well-being in Africa. 2025. Available online [here](#).

Knowledge translation and public engagement

2026

- Presenter, UNICEF Webinar (November)

2025

- Presenter, Centre for Evidence-Based Interventions, DSPI, University of Oxford (November)
- Presenter, Accelerate Research Hub Research-in-Progress Meeting, University of Oxford & University of Cape Town (November)

2024

- Head Country Delegate of Bangladesh, Model WTO Conference on Subsidies and Environment, WTO and University of St. Gallen (March)

2018

- Delegate of Brunei Economy, Model APEC Conference on MSMEs in Digital Era (May)

Peer review

2026

- Reviewer, *Journal of Adolescent Health*

Voluntary services

- City Ambassador London, MIT Alumni Startups (exp. 2027)
- Mentor at Refugee-Led Research Hub, University of Oxford (2024-2025)
- Volunteer at Changcheng Love Camp, Weihai City, China (2017-2021)
- Enactus World, XJTLU (2017-2018)

Language and software skills

Language: English (proficient), Chinese (native)

Software: Python, Stata, R, Excel, Matlab, SurveyCTO, NVivo, LaTeX, ArcGIS (learning)